

# Still Doing Recon Manually? You’re Wasting Time — Recon Smarter😎, Not Harder

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**Hello, hacker friends and brothers!**

Let's be real — recon is the most boring part of bug hunting.

But it's also the part that decides whether you find bugs or waste time staring at dead ends.

You can have payloads, Burp Suite, and every tool on your box. Doesn't matter. If your recon is weak, you're just guessing in the dark.

Good recon gives you:

- More attack surface
- More hidden endpoints
- More forgotten assets
- More bugs
- More bounty 

The problem?

Doing everything manually gets exhausting.

Subfinder.

httpx.

Waybackurls.

GF.

FFUF.

Repeat.

Again and again.

For every target.

After a while, you spend more time typing commands than actually hunting bugs.

So I asked myself:

**Why not automate the boring stuff?**

## Why Automate Recon?

A simple automation workflow can save a lot of time.

Benefits include:

 Less manual work  Faster target mapping  No missed steps  More consistency  More time for actual bug hunting  Run while you sleep 😴

Automation won't find bugs for you.

But it will help you find where bugs are hiding.

And that's the real game.

## My Basic Recon Workflow

Whenever I test a new target, I usually follow this flow:

Target → Subdomains → Live Hosts → Historical URLs → Parameters → Hidden Endpoints → Vulnerability Patterns

Simple.

Fast.

Effective.

## Step 1: Subdomain Enumeration

First, I want to know what assets belong to the target.

```
subfinder -d target.com -silent > subs.txt
```

This pulls subdomains from passive sources like:

- Certificate Transparency Logs
- Search Engines
- Public APIs

More subdomains means more attack surface.

## Step 2: Find Live Hosts

Not every subdomain is alive.

That's where httpx helps.

```
cat subs.txt | httpx -silent > live.txt
```

If you want more detail:

```
httpx -title -status-code -tech-detect
```

Now you can quickly see:

- Status codes
- Page titles
- Technologies used

## Step 3: Check Archived URLs

Archived URLs often reveal forgotten endpoints.

```
cat live.txt | waybackurls > wayback.txt
```

These old URLs can lead to:

- Admin panels
- Legacy APIs
- Hidden endpoints
- Deprecated features

Some of the best findings come from old stuff developers forgot about.

## Step 4: Find Hidden Parameters

Parameters are often where bugs live.

Examples:

```
?id=
?user=
?redirect=
?url=
?file=
```

These can lead to:

- XSS
- IDOR
- Open Redirect
- SSRF
- LFI

Using ParamSpider:

```
paramspider -d target.com -o params.txt
```

This helps collect parameterized endpoints fast.

## Step 5: Filter Interesting URLs

Now it's time to reduce noise.

GF patterns make this much easier.

Potential XSS:

```
cat wayback.txt | gf xss > xss.txt
```

SQLi:

```
cat wayback.txt | gf sqli > sqli.txt
```

LFI:

```
cat wayback.txt | gf lfi > lfi.txt
```

Open Redirect:

```
cat wayback.txt | gf redirect > redirect.txt
```

Instead of checking thousands of URLs manually, GF gives you a shortlist.

## Step 6: Directory Bruteforcing

Sometimes the best findings are hidden, not linked.

That's where FFUF comes in.

```
ffuf -u https://target.com/FUZZ -w /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt -mc 200
```

FFUF can uncover:

- Admin panels
- Login pages
- Backup files

- Config files
- Hidden directories

You can also test extensions:

```
ffuf -u https://target.com/FUZZ -w wordlist.txt -e .php,.bak,.zip
```

Never ignore backup files.

## Putting Everything Together

Instead of running everything by hand, I prefer putting it into one recon script.

That way:

1. Enter target
2. Start recon
3. Grab coffee ☕
4. Come back to organized results

Automation doesn't replace skill.

It just removes repetitive work so you can focus on what matters:

**Finding vulnerabilities.**

## Final Thoughts

A lot of beginners spend too much time learning exploitation and not enough time learning recon.

That's a mistake.

The best bug hunters aren't always the ones with the fanciest payloads.

They're the ones who consistently find the most attack surface.

And good recon is how you do that.

Automate the boring work.

Stay organized.

Spend more time testing.

Let the scripts handle the repetitive stuff while you focus on hunting bugs.

**Happy Hunting!** □☠

— S4YEM.7KuroX

GoodBye